

Midterm Project

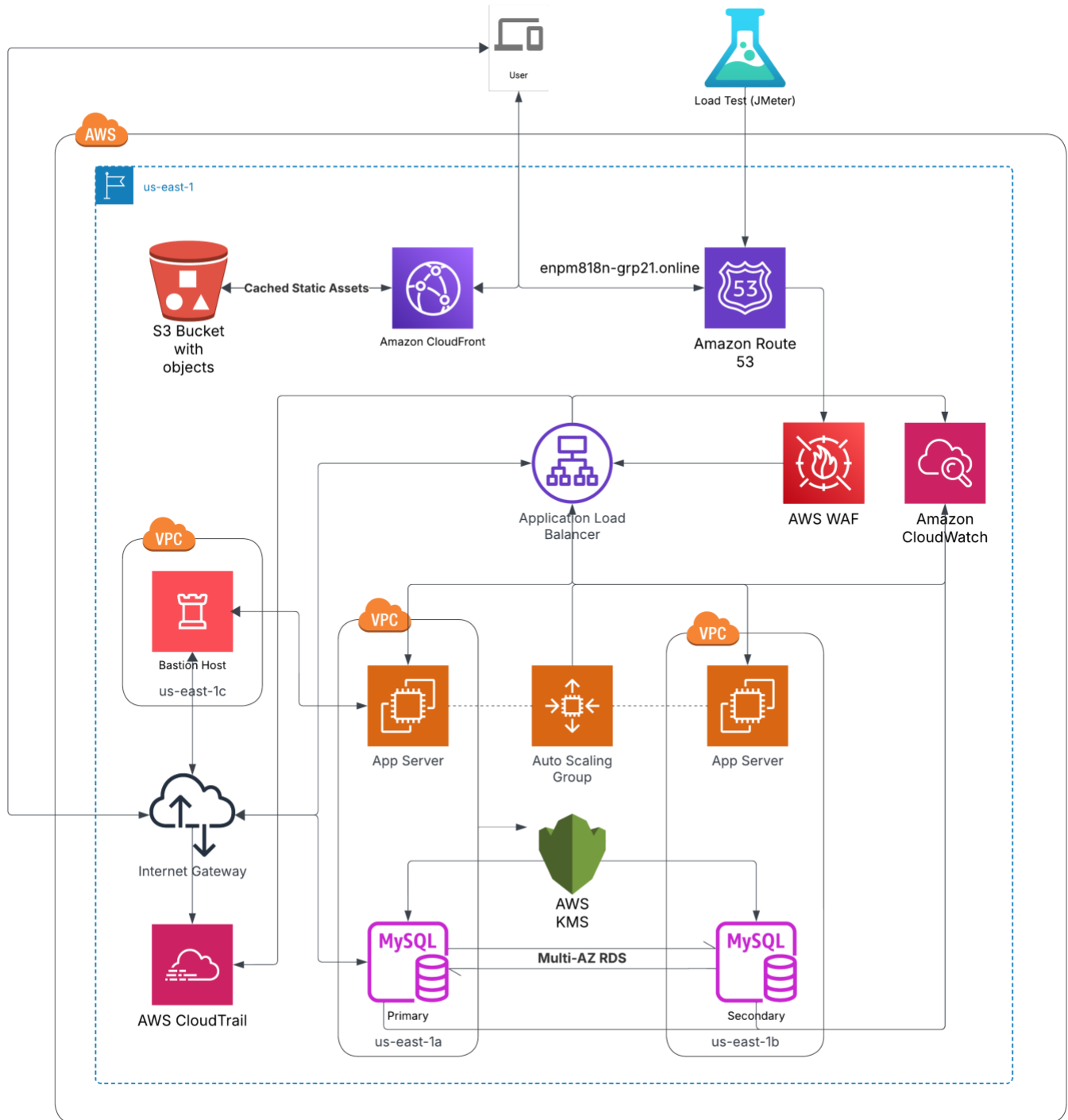
ENPM818N – Group 21

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1. Architecture Diagram



2. Phase-wise Deliverables

a. Phase-1: EC2 Instances, Load Balancer, Auto Scaling, and RDS Setup

The successful implementation of this phase will achieve the following:

- Fully functional EC2 instances running a web server with an e-commerce application.
- Application Load Balancer (ALB) to distribute incoming traffic among EC2 instances.
- Auto Scaling Group to automatically adjust the number of instances based on CPU utilization or traffic patterns.
- RDS MySQL with Multi-AZ deployment for high availability, data encryption using AWS KMS, and database tables for products, users, and orders.
- CloudWatch Alarms configured to trigger Auto Scaling based on CPU usage.

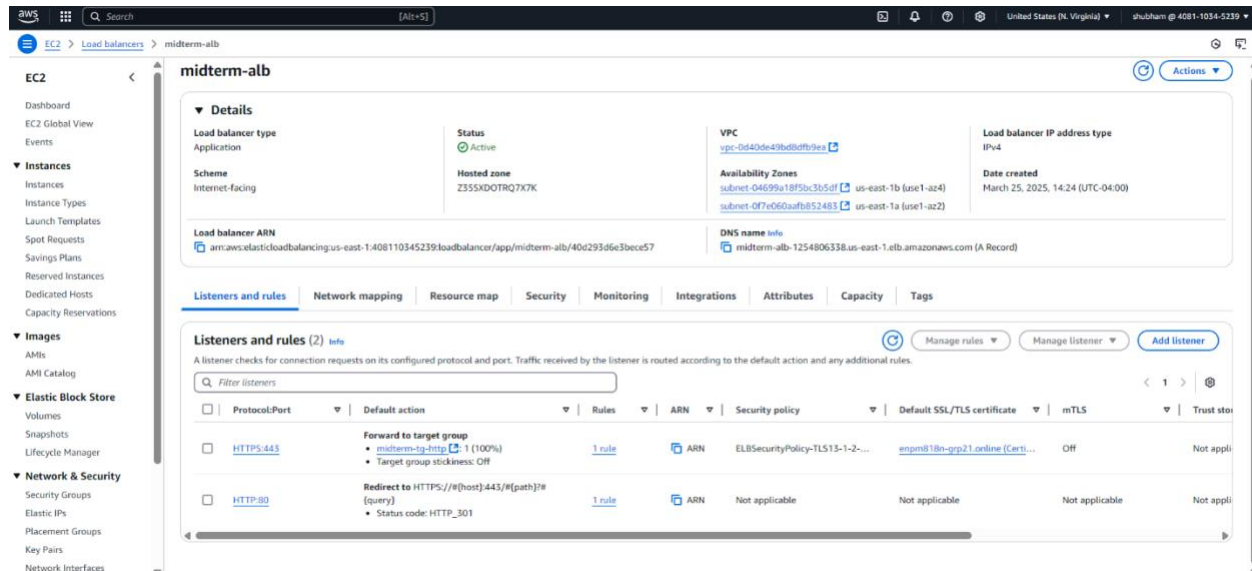
Implementation Details

1. AMI Creation. The web server AMI is created with the following configuration:
 - Base Image: Ubuntu (Latest LTS version)
 - AMI Type: Pre-configured custom AMI
 - Installed Software:
 - Web Server: Apache (or NGINX)
 - Programming Environment: PHP, Node.js, MySQL Client
 - Security Updates: Latest OS patches and security configurations
 - Application Setup:
 - The e-commerce platform files are stored in /var/www/html/
 - Database connection settings are pre-configured to connect to Amazon RDS MySQL
2. Auto Scaling Configuration.
 - Launch Template: Defines the configuration for launching EC2 instances, including AMI, instance type, and security settings.
 - Auto Scaling Group (ASG):
 - Automatically increases or decreases the number of EC2 instances based on predefined conditions.
 - Ensures at least one instance is always running (minimum size).
 - Restricts the maximum number of instances to three (scalable if required).
 - Scaling Policies:
 - Scaling is triggered based on CPU utilization exceeding a 50% threshold.
 - Additional instances are launched when traffic spikes.
 - When demand decreases, extra instances are terminated to optimize costs.
3. RDS MySQL Setup.
 - Database Engine: MySQL is used for managing the backend data.
 - Multi-AZ Deployment: The database is deployed in multiple availability zones to ensure high availability and automatic failover in case of an outage.
 - Security Features:

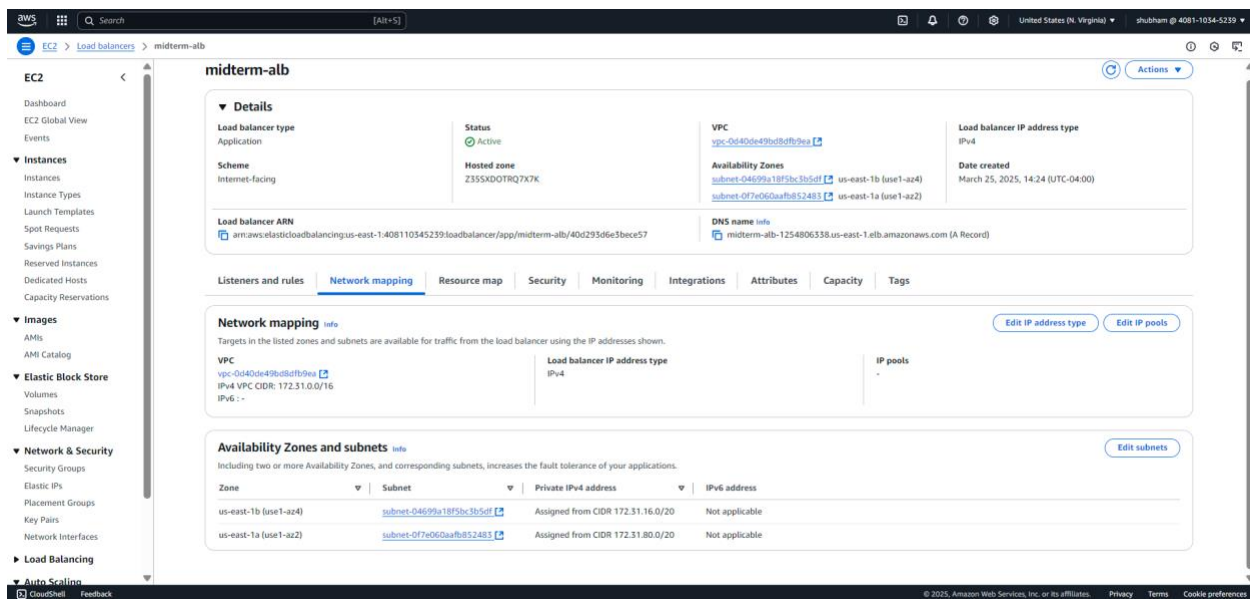
- Amazon KMS encryption ensures that stored data is encrypted at rest.
 - A dedicated security group is configured to allow access only from EC2 instances.
 - Database Schema:
 - The database includes tables for managing users, products, and orders.
 - Supports basic CRUD (Create, Read, Update, Delete) operations for handling transactions and user interactions.
4. ALB Setup.
- Application Load Balancer (ALB) deployed across multiple Availability Zones for high availability.
 - Security Group: Allows inbound traffic on port 443 (HTTPS) only.
 - VPC & Subnets: Configured within a designated VPC, spanning multiple subnets for redundancy.
 - Target Group Type: Instance-based, forwarding traffic to EC2 instances.
 - Listener: HTTPS (Port 443). Uses AWS Certificate Manager (ACM) for SSL/TLS encryption.
 - Routing: Default rule routes traffic towards the target group.
5. CloudWatch Monitoring and Alerts.
- Database Engine: MySQL is used for managing the backend data.
 - Multi-AZ Deployment: The database is deployed in multiple availability zones to ensure high availability and automatic failover in case of an outage.
 - Security Features:
 - Amazon KMS encryption ensures that stored data is encrypted at rest.
 - A dedicated security group is configured to allow access only from EC2 instances.
 - Database Schema:
 - The database includes tables for managing users, products, and orders.
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b. Phase-2: Security Configurations

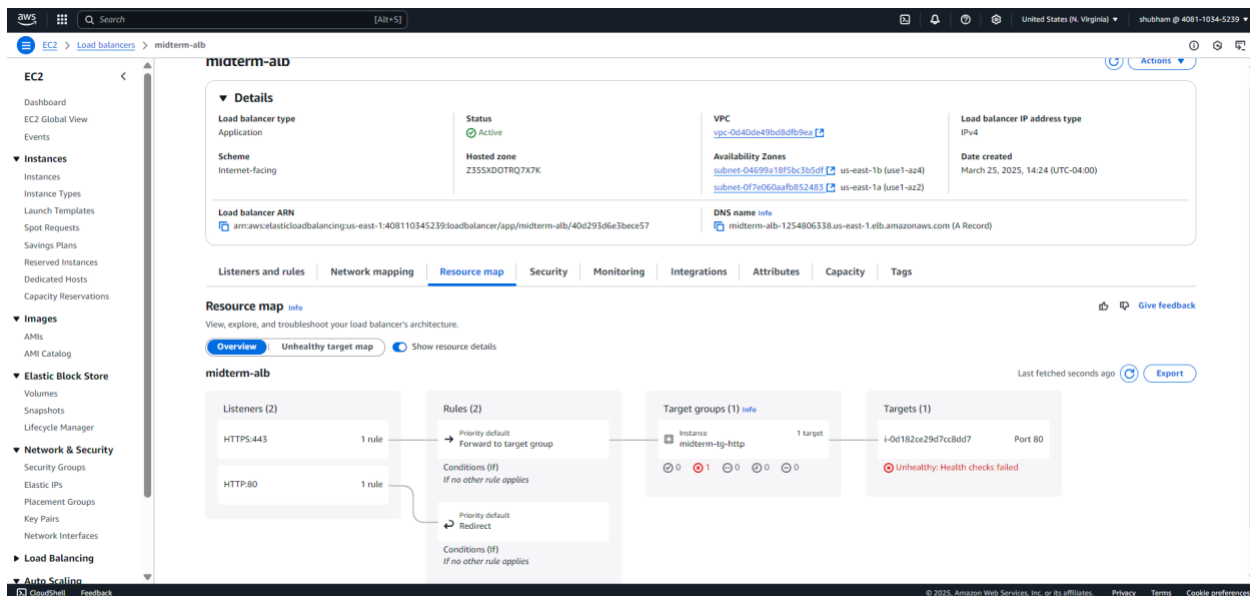
1. The image below depicts the midterm-alb, which is aimed to improve the availability and performance of our e-commerce platform by equally distributing incoming traffic. It runs in two Availability Zones (us-east-1a and us-east-1b), which improves availability and resilience by routing traffic between them.



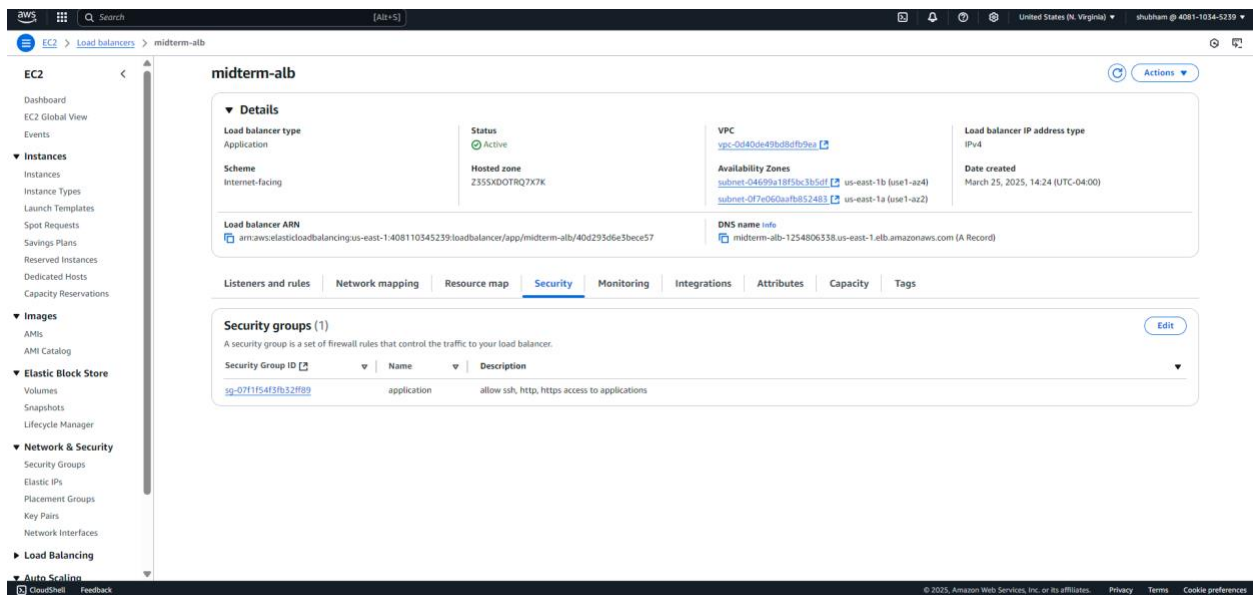
2. The load balancer has two listeners: HTTP on port 80 and HTTPS on port 443. The HTTP listener capture and redirect unencrypted requests to HTTPS with a 301 status code, ensuring all communication is safe. The HTTPS listener routes encrypted requests to the midterm-tg-http, which distributes them among EC2 instances in the Auto Scaling Group. The HTTPS listener is configured with SSL/TLS certificates for the domain enpm818n-grp21.online, ensuring data privacy and integrity. Furthermore, a security policy (ELBSecurityPolicy-TLS13-1-2-2021-06) enforces secure protocols to provide a secure connection for all user traffic. The load balancer, with its dual listener setup and security restrictions, provides a reliable way to handle user traffic.



- The load balancer works in an internet-facing approach within the vpc-0d40de49bd8dfb9ea VPC, which has an IPv4 CIDR block of 172.31.0.0/16. This configuration employs two Availability Zones—us-east-1a and us-east-1b—each with a specific public subnet (172.31.80.0/16 for us-east-1a and 172.31.16.0/16 for us-east-1b).



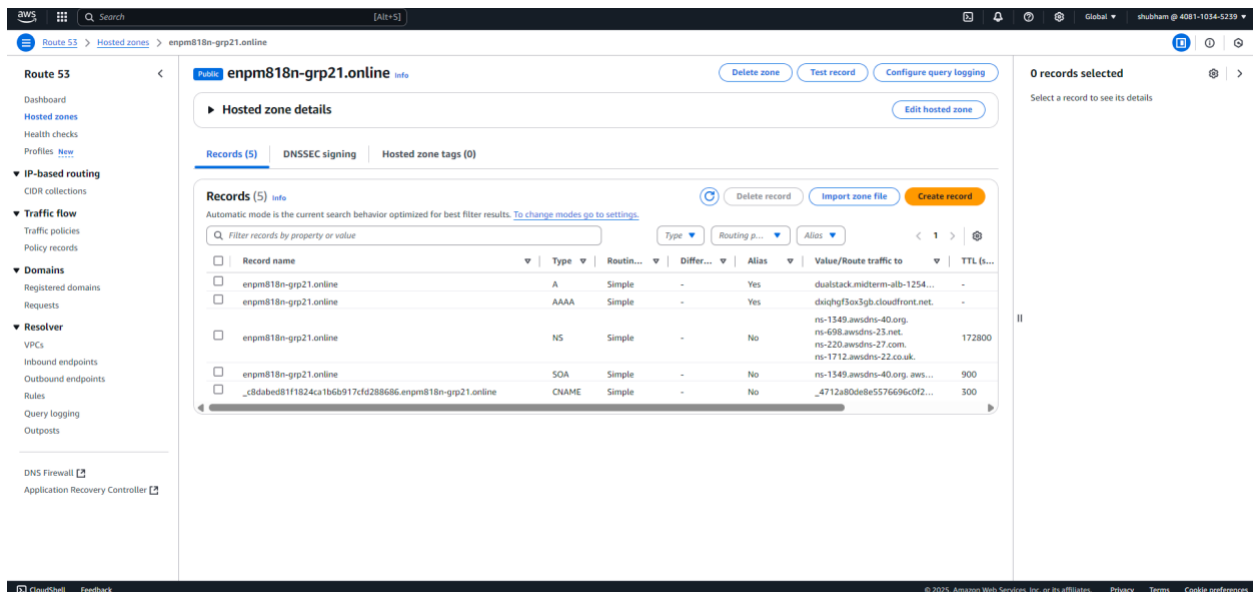
- The HTTPS listener routes encrypted traffic to a specific target group, midterm-tg-http, which includes one registered EC2 instance on port 80.



5. The midterm-alb is protected by a specific security group (sg-07f1f54f3fb32ff89), which is set to accept SSH, HTTP, and HTTPS connections. This security group is responsible for controlling and filtering inbound traffic, ensuring that only web traffic on ports 80 (HTTP) and 443 (HTTPS) can reach the load balancer and SSH on port 22.

6. Route 53

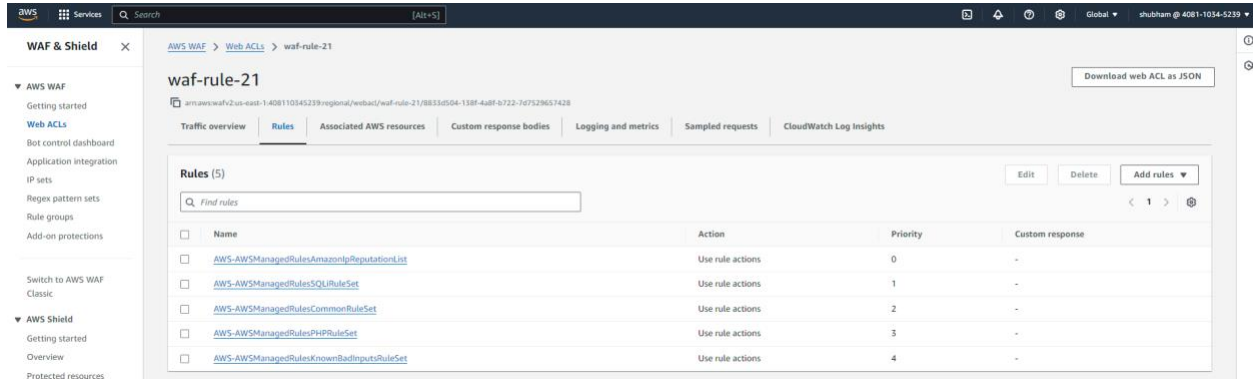
- AWS provides Route53, a service that allows us to handle DNS for our domain. This is accomplished by simply referring the domain to the AWS nameservers specified in the hosted zone.



7. Additionally an A record pointing to the Load Balancer and a CNAME record needed to issue the SSL certificate for the domain.

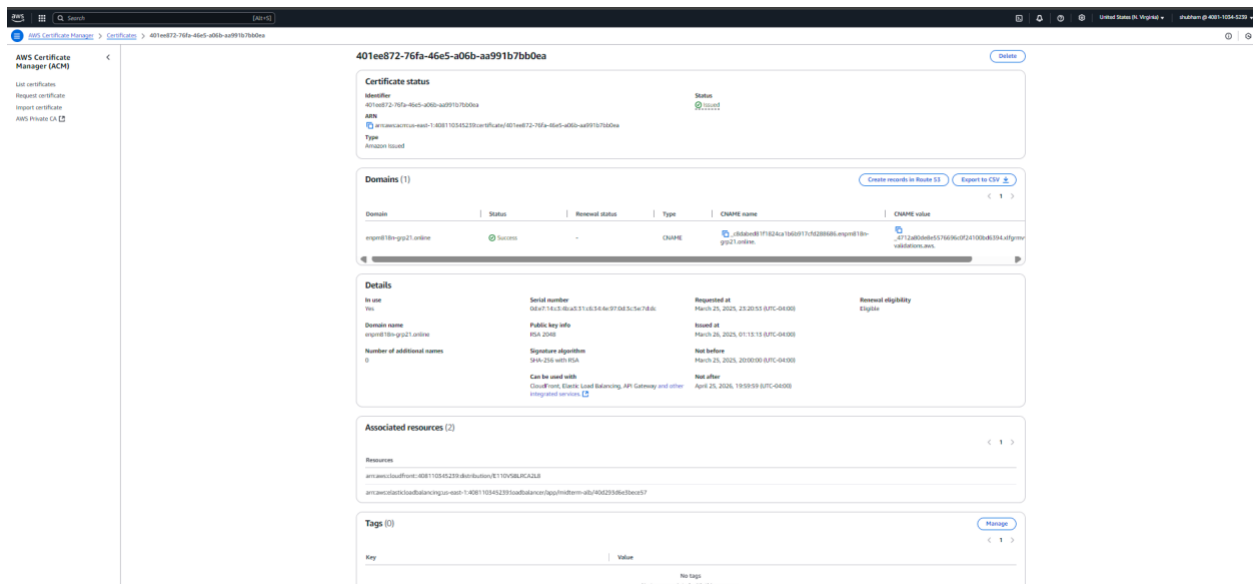
8. Waf:

- The WAF configuration for "waf-rule-21" contains a large number of managed rule groups, including the AWSManagedRulesAmazonIpReputationList, SQLiRuleSet, CommonRuleSet, PHPRuleSet, and KnownBadInputsRuleSet. With a Web ACL capacity consumption of 1225 out of 5000 WCUs, the configuration is well within restrictions, optimizing security without sacrificing performance. The default action is set to "Allow" for requests that do not fit any specified criteria, ensuring a balanced security approach while allowing required traffic.



9. Security Measures:

- SSL for domain: According to our architecture's process, when our domain enpm818n-grp21.online is accessed, Route53 routes the request through Cloudfront and WAF before sending it to the Load Balancer. Because our website is an e-commerce site, sensitive data, such as login information, order details, payment information, and so on, must be encrypted while in transit. To do this, we enabled an SSL certificate from AWS Certificate Manager (ACM) on our domain, which is also related with the Load balancer and CloudFront services we utilized.



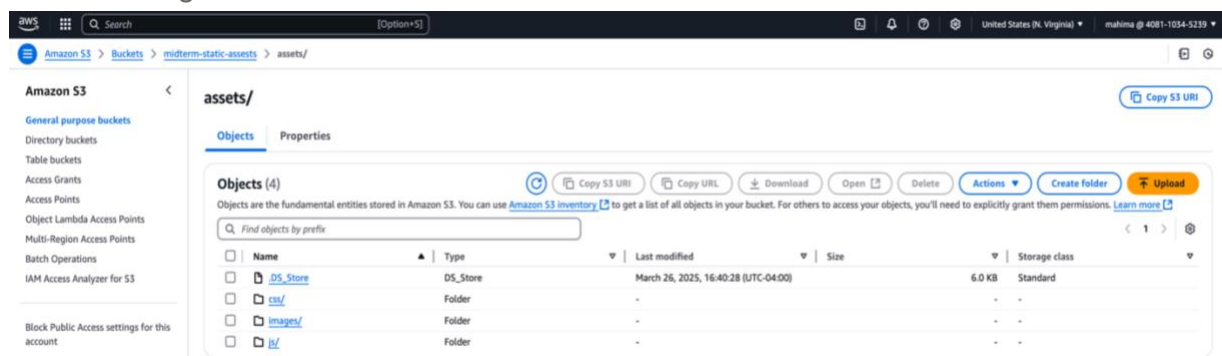
c. Phase-3: CloudFront Setup and Performance Tuning

AWS CloudFront was used to cache and deliver static assets such as CSS, JavaScript, and images, improving website performance. By serving content from the nearest edge location, it reduces load times and decreases latency. This setup optimizes content delivery, minimizes the load on the origin server, and enhances the user experience. With a globally distributed network, CloudFront ensures fast and reliable access to static resources.

Setup:

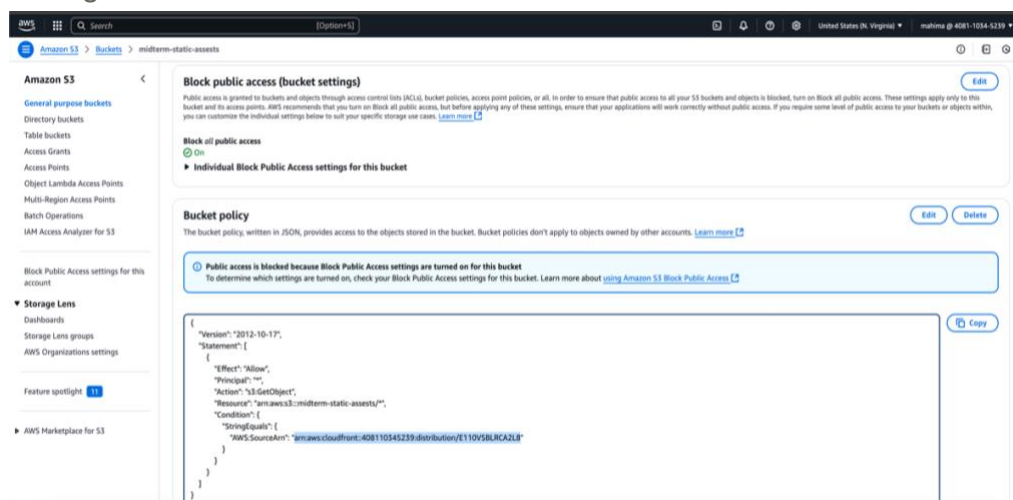
1. Creation of S3 Bucket for storing Static Assests

- The midterm-static-assests S3 bucket was put up to act as CloudFront's origin, offering centralised storage for items such as pictures, CSS, and JavaScript. As seen by the arrangement under the "assets" directory in the S3 configuration, this structure guarantees simpler file administration and retrieval by grouping assets under specific folders—css, js, and images.



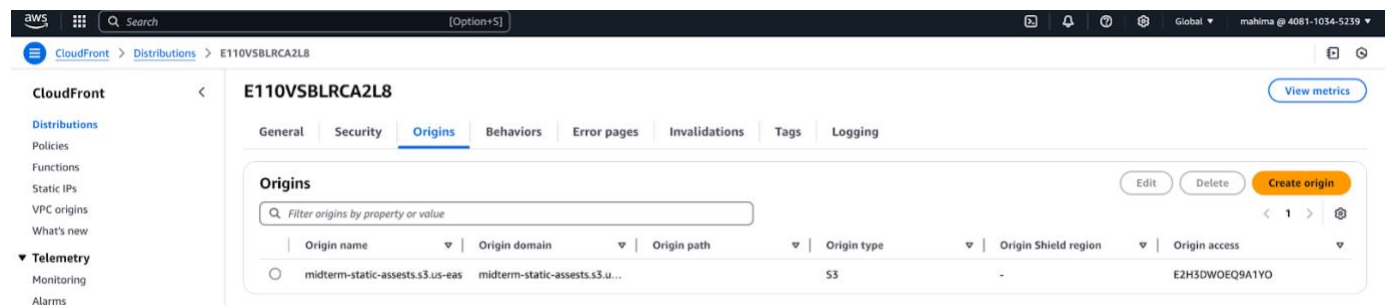
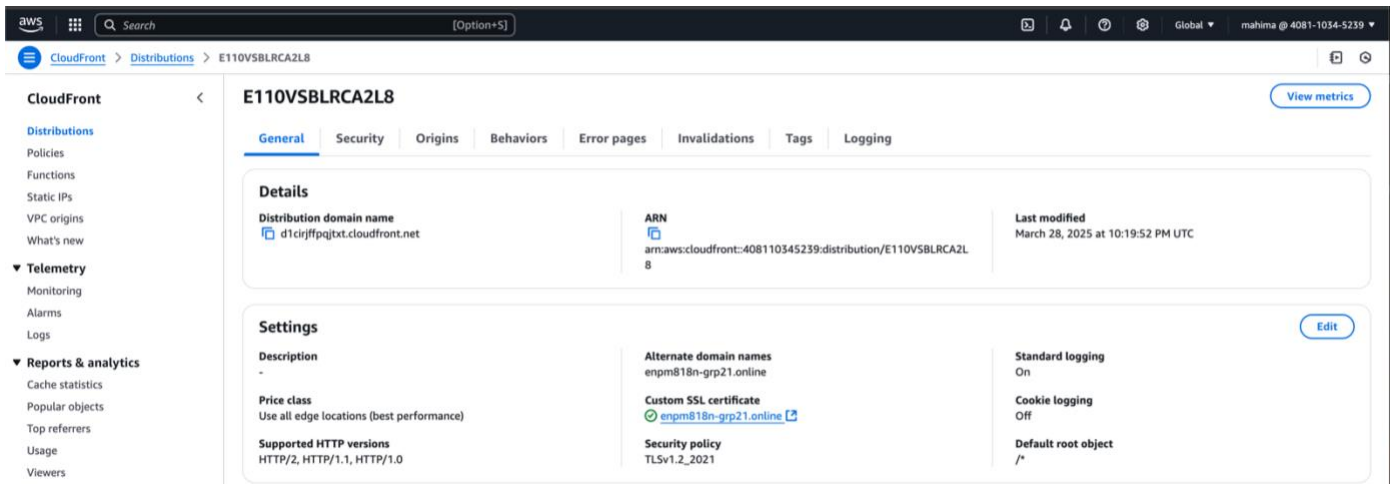
2. Enhancing Security in S3 and CloudFront Integration

- Blocking Public Access – The S3 bucket is fully restricted from public access to prevent unauthorized usage.
- Origin Access Control (OAC) Implementation – OAC ensures that the S3 bucket is accessible only through CloudFront, enhancing security.
- Controlled Access via CloudFront – A bucket policy allows only the designated CloudFront distribution to retrieve objects by granting permission for the s3:GetObject action, while restricting direct access.



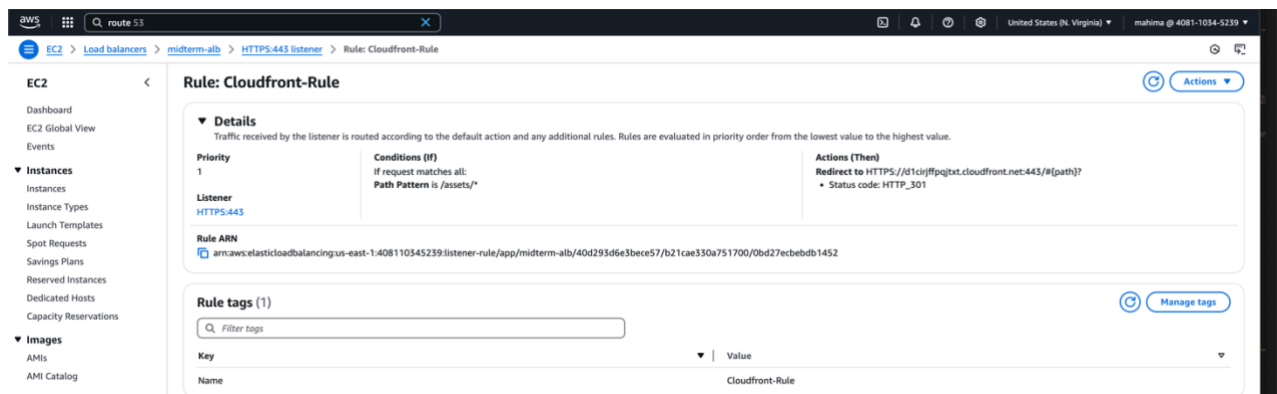
3. CloudFront Distribution

- To improve load speeds by retrieving assets from edge locations closest to users, a CloudFront distribution E110V5BLRCA2L8 was created to cache and distribute content globally.



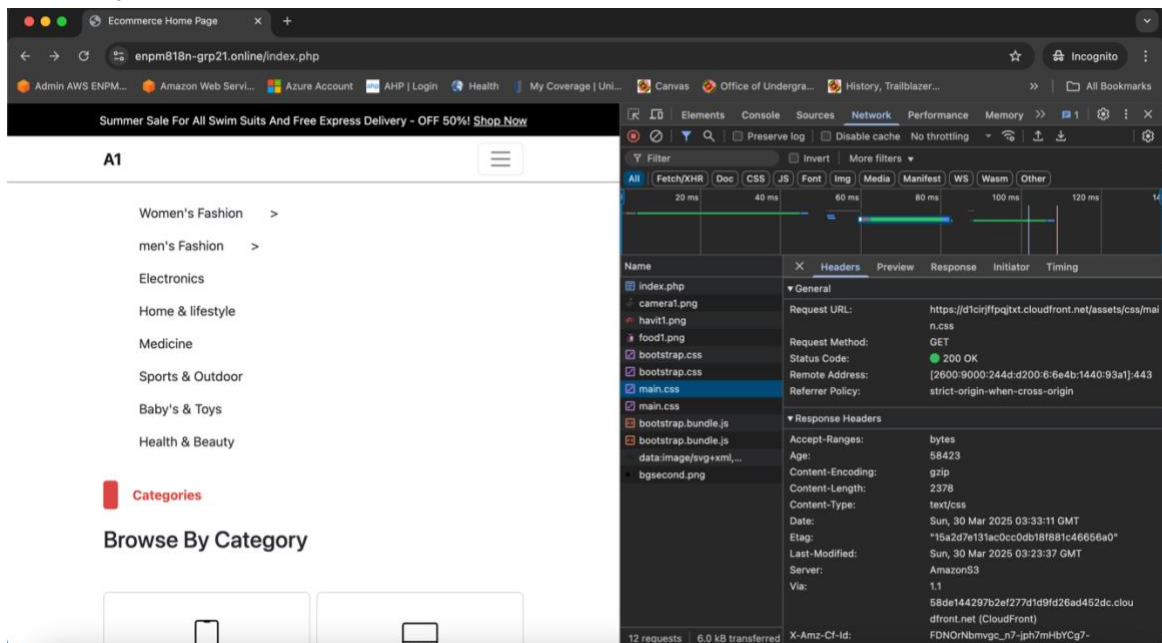
4. Redirecting to CloudFront URL.

- To leverage the benefits of the CDN, the Application Load Balancer (ALB) is configured with a listener rule that matches requests to the /assets/* path and redirects them to the CloudFront distribution's URL (<https://d1cirffpqjtxt.cloudfront.net>).
- How It Works:**
 - > **Client Request:** A user requests a resource, such as <https://enpm818n-grp21.online/assets/images/bg.png>
 - > **ALB Evaluation:** The ALB evaluates the incoming request against its listener rules. Upon matching the path condition /assets/*, it triggers the redirect action.
 - > **Redirect Response:** The ALB responds with an HTTP 301 or 302 redirect status, instructing the client's browser to fetch the requested resource from the specified CloudFront URL, for example, <https://d1cirffpqjtxt.cloudfront.net/assets/images/bg.png>
 - > **Client Follows Redirect:** The client's browser follows the redirect to the CloudFront URL to retrieve the asset.



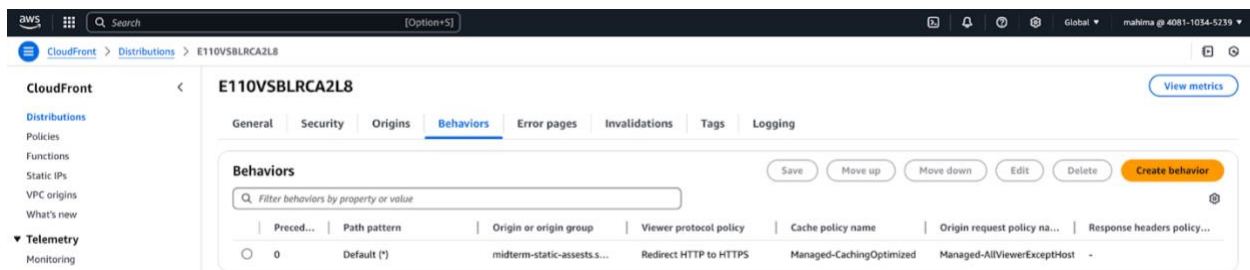
5. Performance Tuning by GZIP Compression:

- The below images illustrates how GZIP compression is successfully applied to static assets in our web application, focusing on the main.css file that is compressed and distributed using **CloudFront**. As indicated by the **Content-Encoding: gzip** response header, CloudFront compresses the CSS file with GZIP, which is critical for optimising web speed.



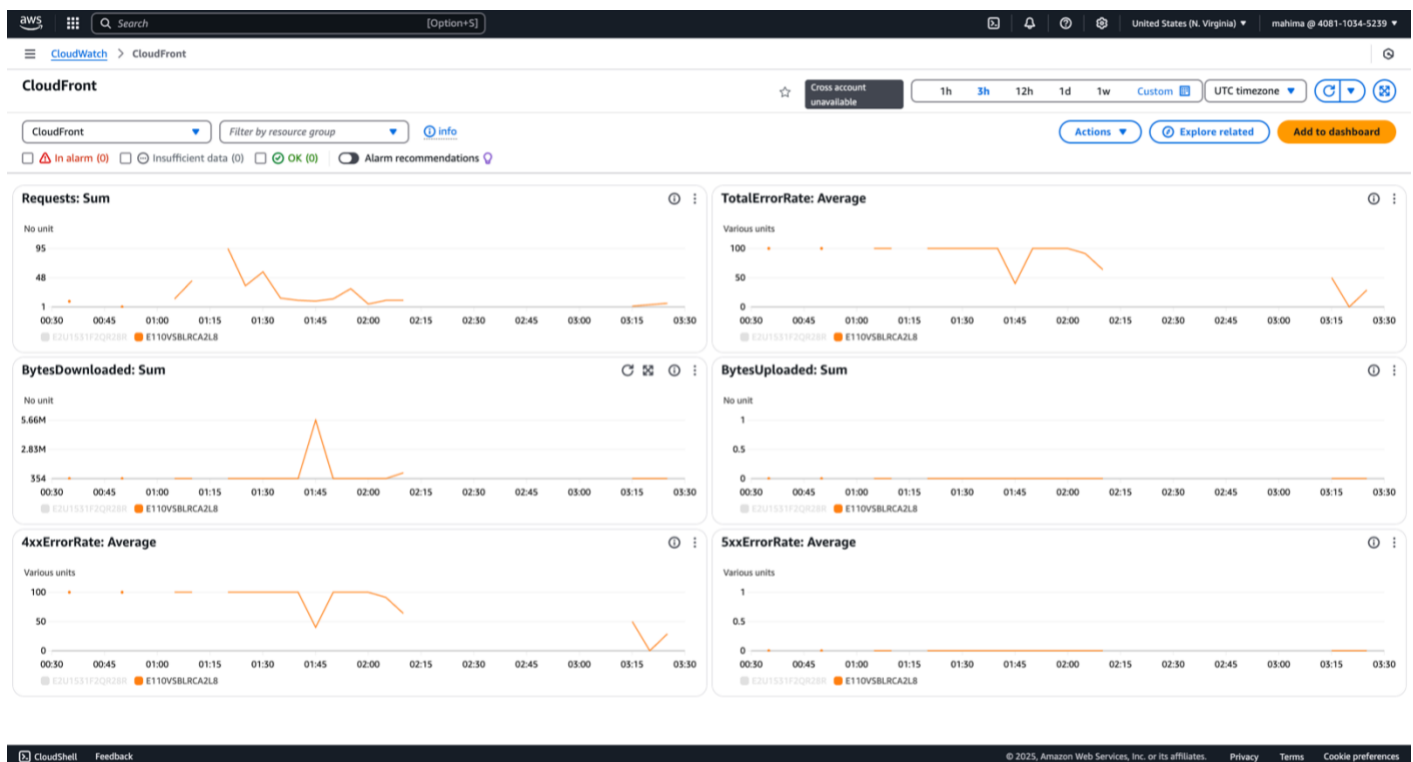
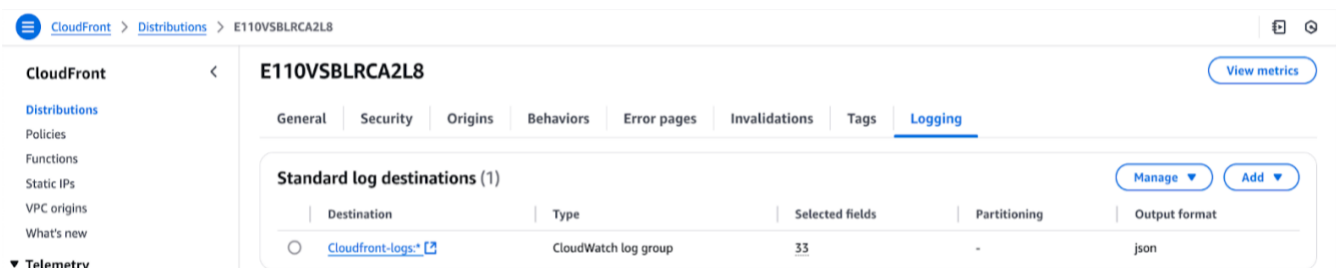
6. Content Caching:

- Applied The "Managed-CachingOptimized" policy helps in caching objects, which reduces the load on the S3 bucket by serving frequently accessed assets directly from the cache (CloudFront edge locations) instead of making repeated requests to the S3 bucket.



7. CloudWatch Logs:

- These are CloudWatch logs for CloudFront, providing detailed insights into the performance and usage of the distribution. They help monitor request patterns, cache hit rates, and detect any potential issues in content delivery.



d. Phase-4: Stress Testing, CloudWatch, Cost Analysis

Objectives:

- Simulate very high user load to test performance limits of an instance in AWS
- Verify Auto Scaling functionality of an EC2 based on thresholds of the CPU usage
- Monitor backend services like the MySQL RDS database and its behaviour under concurrent access and heavy queries
- Validate our CloudWatch dashboard's visibility across metrics we deemed critical like CPU utilization and such
- Confirm events are captured via CloudTrail which are both infrastructure and management driven
- Analyze AWS billing trends with the help of Cost Explorer and provide cost optimizations

This involved the development and execution of a stress test that checked both application layer (web and API) and data layer (RDS), and observed infrastructure behavior for an extended time window.

Infrastructure:

The core architecture consists of multiple layers such as:

- Application Layer- EC2 instances in an Auto Scaling Group behind an Application Load Balancer. The instances run an e-commerce web application built on Node.js with Apache, using a custom AMI which is essentially a bootstrap.
- Data Layer: An Amazon RDS like a MySQL instance with Multi-AZ configuration for high availability can also provision data durability and encryption.
- Load Distribution: AWS load balancers can route incoming traffic to healthy targets across different zones.
- Monitoring: AWS CloudWatch and AWS CloudTrail are some great tools for system metrics, logs, and auditing.

Stress Testing Strategy

- Tools and Configuration: Apache JMeter was chosen due to its reliability in generating HTTP traffic. A test plan was written in .jmx format, which outlined several thread groups (virtual users) with varied arrival rates and request types.
We used ramp-up times to build the load gradually and provide Auto Scaling Group time to react. Threads were executed in loops to enable continuous activity.
- Request Types Simulated:
 - GET Requests:
 - Home page (/)
 - Product listing pages (/products, /products?category=electronics)
 - Product detail views (/products/:id)
 - Static assets (CSS, JS, images)
 - POST Requests:
 - /login: Simulating user logins

- /cart: Adding and updating cart contents
- /checkout: Finalizing purchases and creating order entries in the database

Every POST request needed backend validation and caused read/write action on the RDS database. This two-tier stress test replicated actual e-commerce behavior to fully test our infrastructure.

- Execution Scale:

We scaled up step by step to 4,000 virtual users. Each user did 3 GETs and 2 POSTs per session cycle. That is, at full load, the system was handling up to 20,000 simultaneous HTTP requests with intensive backend database activity.

- RDS stress test:

We created a simulated spike of activity to evaluate the performance of the RDS instance by sending a high volume of requests (`GET` and `POST`) to the endpoints that were providing the requested data from the database. We simulated concurrent database read/write behavior utilizing Apache JMeter, in order to simulate load testing under a simulated real user behavior. We were testing the RDS instance under high load and concurrent reads/writes to see how it performed. Results were extremely favorable — the APDEX score was 1.0, meaning that users are likely to be very satisfied with response times. Of the 1000 requests, the system reported zero failures, an average response time of 19.66 ms, maximum response time of 231 ms — and all 90th, 95th, and 99th percentiles latencies were under 100 ms. We also observed a steady transactional throughput lasting around 50.32 transactions per second and all transactions were returned without any errors or timeouts. The results confirmed the RDS instance and the application layer adequately supports peak load while maintaining performance reliability.

APDEX (Application Performance Index)

Apdex ▲	T (Toleration threshold) ◆	F (Frustration threshold) ◆	Label ◆
1.000	500 ms	1 sec 500 ms	Total
1.000	500 ms	1 sec 500 ms	Hit Load Balancer

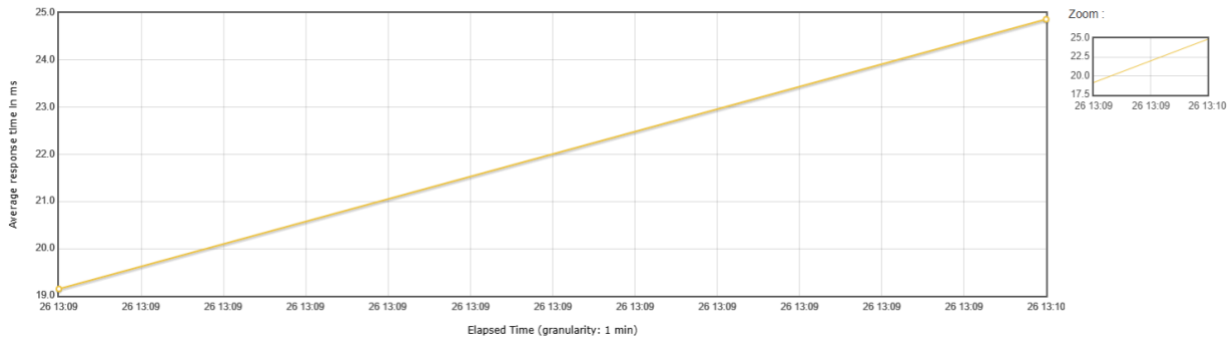
Statistics

Requests	Executions			Response Times (ms)								Throughput	Network (KB/sec)	
	Label ▲	#Samples ◆	FAIL ◆	Error % ◆	Average ◆	Min ◆	Max ◆	Median ◆	90th pct ◆	95th pct ◆	99th pct ◆	Transactions/s ◆	Received ◆	Sent ◆
Total		1000	0	0.00%	19.66	12	231	15.00	37.00	46.00	60.00	50.32	1655.38	7.52
Hit Load Balancer		1000	0	0.00%	19.66	12	231	15.00	37.00	46.00	60.00	50.32	1655.38	7.52

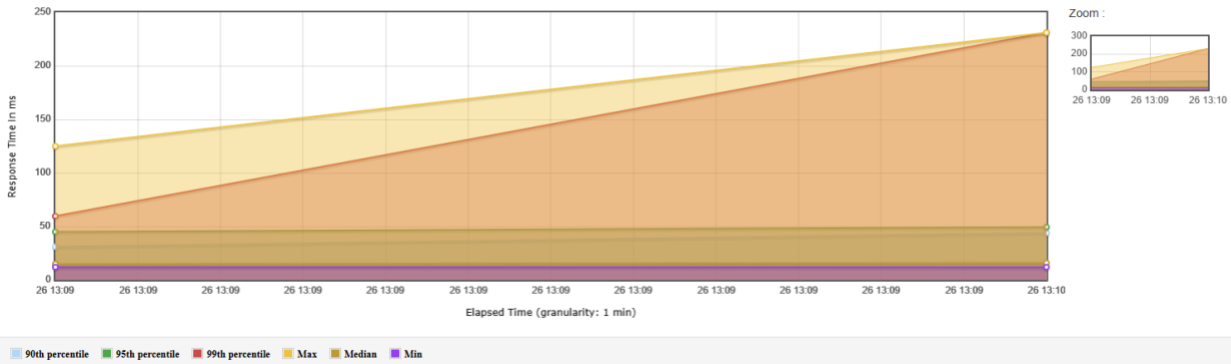
Errors

Type of error ◆	Number of errors ▼	% in errors ◆	% in all samples ◆
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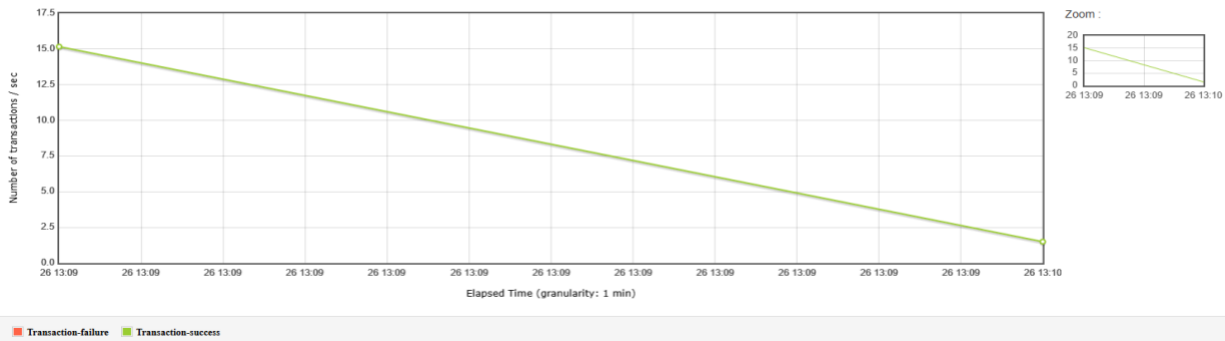
Response Times Over Time



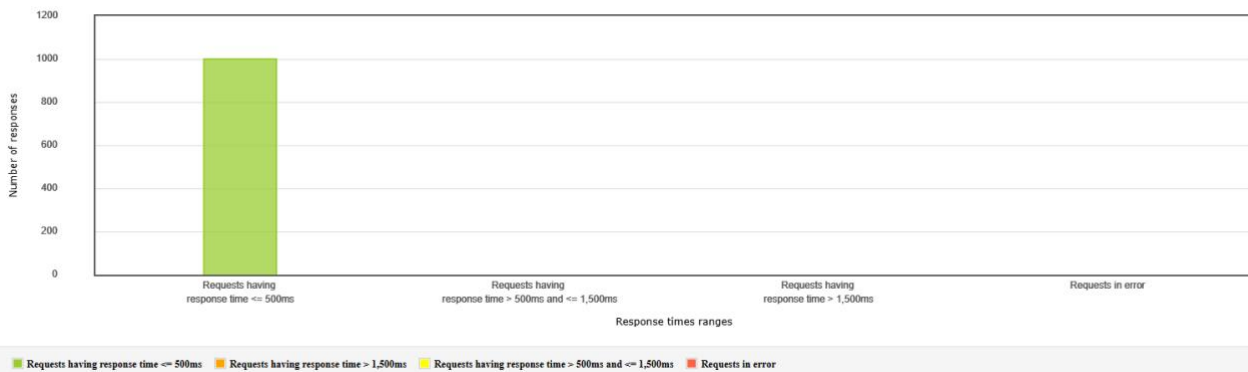
Response Time Percentiles Over Time (successful responses)



Total Transactions Per Second



Response Time Overview



Responses occurs each time without fail

- RDS Load and Performance

RDS performance metrics were tracked using CloudWatch and the instances were stressed and during peak POST activity, the following patterns emerged:

- CPU Utilization increased from approximately 3-4% baseline to over 50% under heavy load
- Database Connections spiked from 5 to 60 concurrent sessions
- Disk Queue Depth showed sudden brief spikes during huge bursts of write queries
- Read/Write Latency remained within thresholds that were acceptable, indicating no blocking of any kind.

Overall, the RDS instance was responsive and stable, vindicating our instance type and provisioning configuration selection. Multi-AZ redundancy offered failover capacity even during heavy load

- Auto Scaling Configuration and Behavior:

Target Tracking Policy

Our ASG was configured with the following:

- Metric: Average CPU utilization
- Target: 50%
- Minimum instances: 1
- Maximum instances: 3
- Warm-up time: 300 seconds
- Scale-in enabled

This setup enabled the platform to react quickly to spiked load, but avoided aggressive back-and-forth scaling by providing a grace period for instances to register into the load balancer and contribute significantly to the load.

Scaling Events Observed:

During testing:

- CPU utilization crossed to about 60%, this in turn started triggering scale-out
- Second and even a third EC2 instances launched and registered, overkill for the stress test.
- Request traffic was distributed by ALB evenly to all instances
- Upon completion of the test, traffic had dropped, and idle instances were scaled in

These events were recorded in the Auto Scaling activity log and verified in CloudTrail logs.

Instances (1/2) Info								Last updated less than a minute ago Refresh Connect	
Find Instance by attribute or tag (case-sensitive)								All states ▾	
☐	Name 🔗	Instance ID	Instance state 🔍	Instance type 🔍	Status check 🔍	Alarm status 🔍	Availability Zone 🔍		
☒		i-0d182ce29d7cc8dd7	Running 🔍 🔍	t2.micro	2/2 checks passed	View alarms +	us-east-1b		
☐		i-0cc566ce8e9657444	Running 🔍 🔍	t2.micro	Initializing	View alarms +	us-east-1a		

Activity history (19)					
Filter activity history < 1 2 >					
Status	Description	Cause	Start time	End time	
Successful	Terminating EC2 instance: i-Occ566ce8e9657444	At 2025-03-28T19:41:19Z a monitor alarm TargetTracking-midterm-asg-AlarmLow-7abbc04f-64ac-4abd-83f4-4adcbdc8ccf7 in state ALARM triggered policy Target Tracking Policy changing the desired capacity from 2 to 1. At 2025-03-28T19:41:26Z an instance was taken out of service in response to a difference between desired and actual capacity, shrinking the capacity from 2 to 1. At 2025-03-28T19:41:26Z instance i-Occ566ce8e9657444 was selected for termination.	2025 March 28, 03:41:26 PM -04:00	2025 March 28, 03:47:09 PM -04:00	
Successful	Launching a new EC2 instance: i-Occ566ce8e9657444	At 2025-03-28T19:19:08Z a monitor alarm TargetTracking-midterm-asg-AlarmHigh-1a610959-cdce-4bc1-9066-f1a859d0ed0a in state ALARM triggered policy Target Tracking Policy changing the desired capacity from 1 to 2. At 2025-03-28T19:19:17Z an instance was started in response to a difference between desired and actual capacity, increasing the capacity from 1 to 2.	2025 March 28, 03:19:19 PM -04:00	2025 March 28, 03:24:25 PM -04:00	

- CloudWatch Monitoring Dashboard

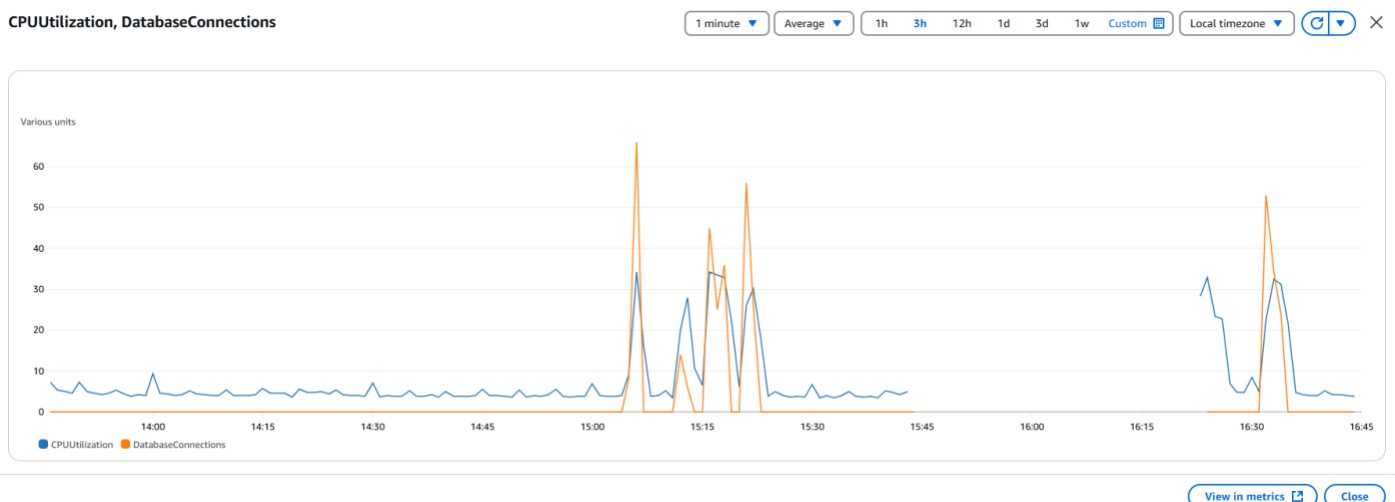
A comprehensive dashboard was created with widgets tracking:

- EC2 instance-level CPU utilization
- Auto Scaling Group instance counts as well as total number of instances
- ALB HTTP error rates and target health
- NetworkIn and NetworkOut metrics
- RDS CPU, latency, and connection count
- S3 and CloudFront throughput

This dashboard enabled real-time visualization while the test was running and helped to correlate spikes in traffic with the relevant scaling and resource metrics.

We used the dashboard to:

- Verify scaling thresholds that were triggered
- Observe CPU utilization rise on each instance as well as the fall
- Confirm that database activity increased significantly during POST-heavy load
- Track 5XX errors, which had remained quite low throughout



GroupInServiceInstances, GroupTotalInstances, RequestCount

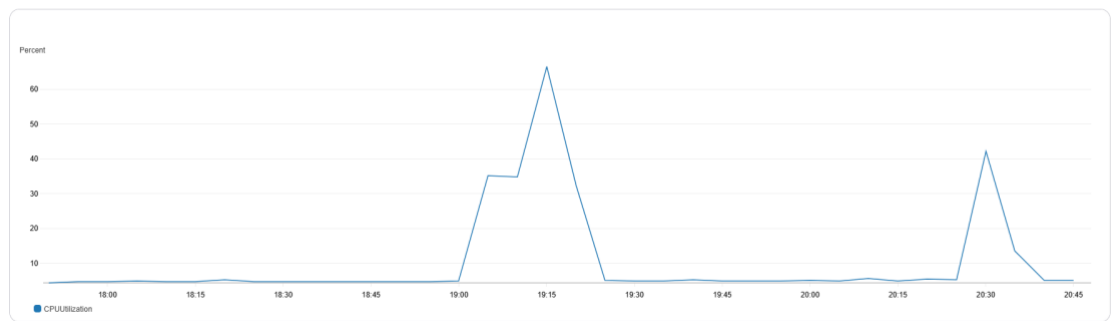
5 minutes Average 1h 3h 12h 1d 3d 1w Custom Local timezone



View in metrics Close

CPU Utilization (Percent)

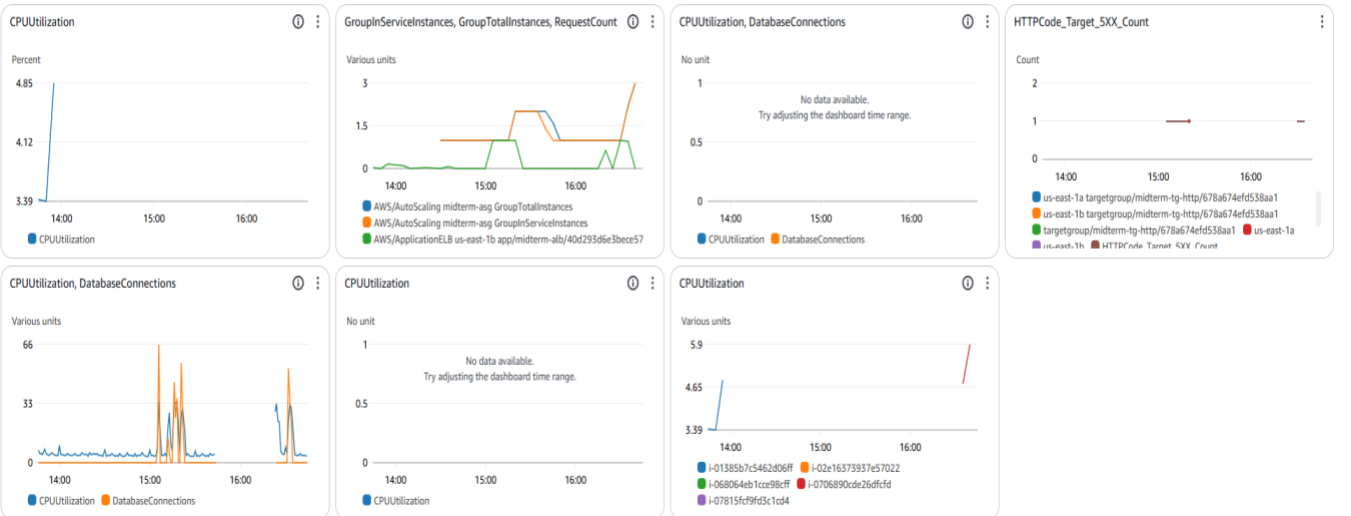
1 minute Average 1h 3h 12h 1d 3d 1w Custom UTC timezone



View in metrics Close

MidtermDashboard

1h 3h 12h 1d 3d 1w Custom Local timezone Actions

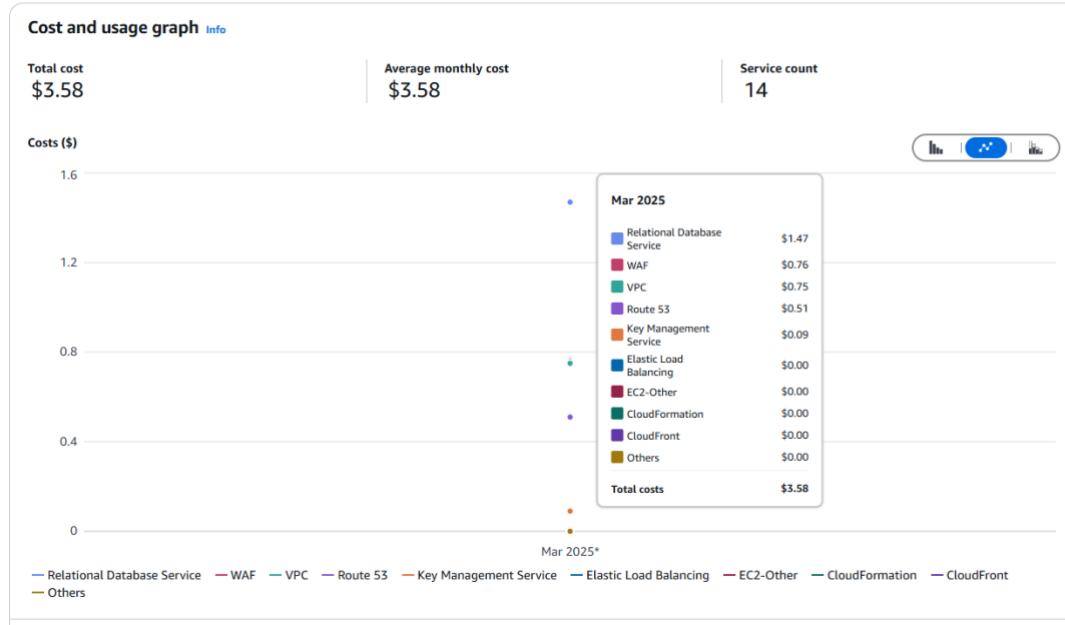


3. Cost Analysis & Optimization Recommendations

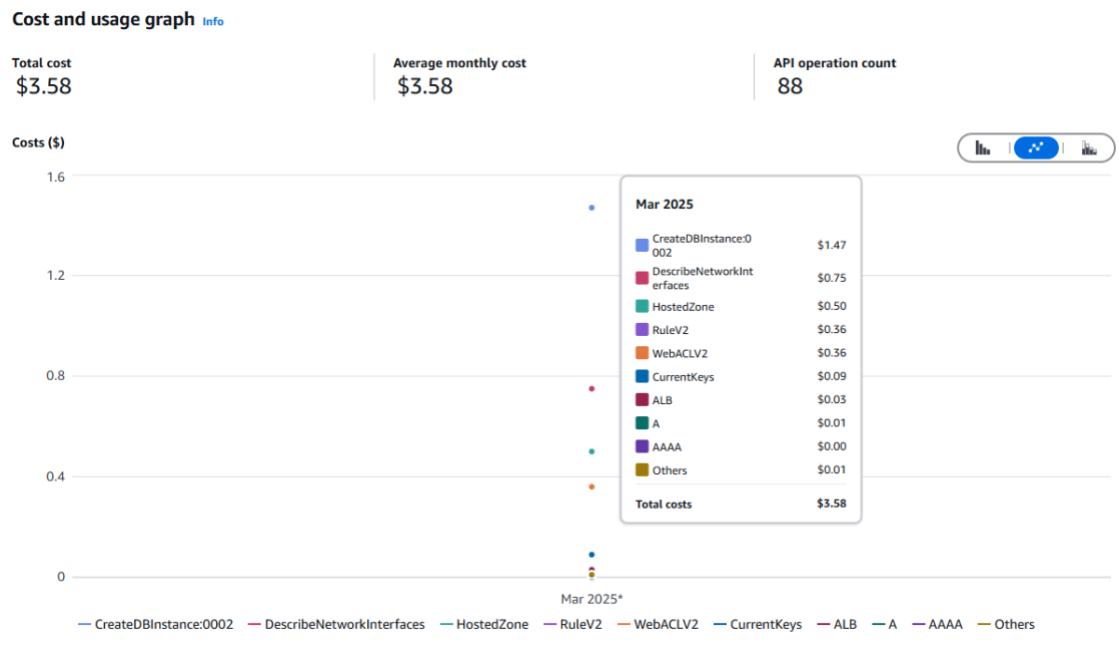
a. Cost Analysis

According to the projected usage by our group for our infrastructure and our e-commerce platform, the EC2 instances and RDS accounted for the majority of billing cost of an estimate of 41%. This can align with the expectation that EC2 and RDS will demand as much according to average AWS resource usage for regular infrastructure. Monitoring tools and the WAF had minimal impact to the cost but is very essential for observability and security.

New cost and usage report

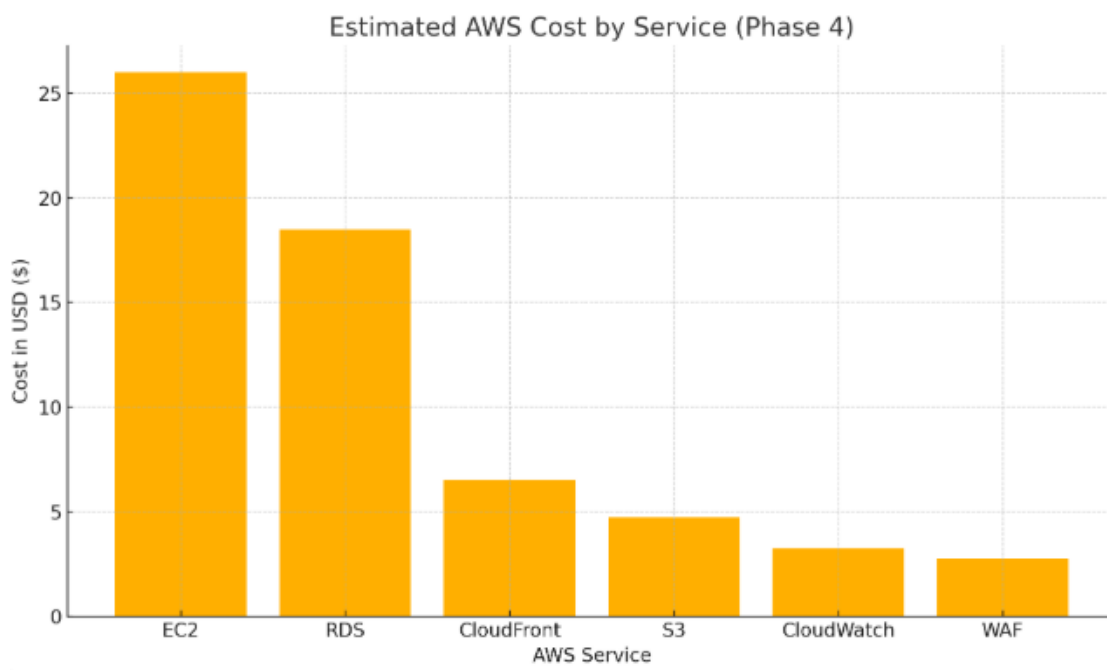
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Usage by services:



Cost per API call:

Since it has not been long, a cost analyzer cannot provide accurate data but we can see more through an approximation given below:



Cost Analysis via AWS Cost Explorer

We analyzed cost data for the current billing cycle. During the stress testing window, we noted:

- EC2 cost had increased due to multi-hour instance provisioning
- CloudWatch costs increased metrics collection and logs and the same was reflected
- RDS usage slightly increased due to significantly higher IOPS
- S3 and CloudFront costs remained low due to effective caching which did not trigger the use of the RDS and object tiering

No major cost anomalies were detected. However, this exercise revealed areas for savings through usage rightsizing and commitments.

b. Optimization Recommendations

1. EC2 Reserved Instances: Converts the baseline EC2 capacity to Reserved Instances to cut cost by a margin of at least 30%.
2. Spot Instances for scale-out: Use Spot Instances for temporary scale-out to, this can reduce variable charges.
3. Database optimization: Enable slow query logging so as to identify high-latency queries and tune appropriately.
4. CloudWatch log retention: Reduce retention up to 7 days.
5. Enable GZIP and caching: Increase compression for dynamic content for faster delivery and less reads to the RDS.
6. Move asset delivery to CloudFront + S3: Offload load from the EC2 instance.
7. Predictive scaling: Train Auto Scaling on historical traffic patterns for instance provisioning.

4. Lessons Learned and Future Improvements

a. Key Challenges

1. EC2 Auto Scaling Configuration
 - Ensuring the Auto Scaling Group properly scales up and down based on CPU utilization without unnecessary resource consumption.
 - Avoiding over-provisioning, which could lead to higher AWS costs.
2. Database Performance and Availability
 - Managing database connections efficiently to prevent bottlenecks.
 - Ensuring proper failover handling in Multi-AZ RDS deployment.
3. Security Configuration
 - Ensuring EC2 security groups and IAM roles follow the principle of least privilege.
4. Balancing GET/POST Requests for Realistic Load Simulation
 - GET requests dominate typical traffic but do not fully test backend performance.
 - POST requests are essential for evaluating database writes and overall backend health.
5. Target Tracking vs. Step Policies in Auto Scaling
 - Target tracking is easier to manage but requires fine-tuning to prevent over/under-scaling.
 - Misconfigured tracking policies may lead to delayed scaling responses.
6. RDS as a Performance Bottleneck
 - High database load due to inefficient queries or insufficient instance sizing.
 - Need for constant monitoring to prevent slow queries and resource exhaustion.
7. Scaling Behavior and Load Balancer Optimization
 - Scaling effectiveness depends on accurate warm-up periods for EC2 instances.
 - Traffic distribution from the ALB needs optimization to avoid overloading specific instances.
8. Observability and Monitoring Challenges
 - Lack of proper logging and metrics can obscure performance issues.
 - Monitoring tools must be actively used to detect issues before they impact users.
9. Content Compression in CloudFront
 - To ensure both CloudFront's "Compress Objects Automatically" setting and origin server's Content-Encoding headers are properly configured.

b. Recommendations

1. Database Performance Best Practices
 - Enable RDS Performance Insights to analyze and optimize query execution.
 - Use Read Replicas for better performance if read-heavy workloads are expected.
2. Security Best Practices
 - Use IAM roles instead of hardcoded credentials in application code.
 - Implement AWS Shield for additional protection against DDoS attacks.
3. Simulate a Realistic Workload in Load Testing
 - Balance GET and POST requests in load tests to reflect actual user interactions.

- Use tools like Apache JMeter or AWS Load Testing to analyze backend performance.
4. Optimize Target Tracking Scaling Policies
 - Regularly adjust CPU utilization thresholds based on traffic patterns.
 - Consider hybrid scaling: Target Tracking for baseline stability and Step Scaling for rapid response to traffic spikes.
 5. Improve RDS Performance and Availability
 - Enable RDS Performance Insights and query optimization for slow queries.
 - Consider Read Replicas for scaling read-heavy workloads.
 - Use RDS Proxy to manage database connections more efficiently.
 6. Fine-Tune Warm-up Periods for EC2 Scaling
 - Set warm-up periods based on historical startup time metrics to prevent premature scaling decisions.
 - Test different ALB traffic routing strategies (e.g., Least Outstanding Requests) for better load distribution.
 7. Enhance Observability with AWS Monitoring Tools
 - Set up CloudWatch Dashboards for CPU, memory, and database metrics.
 - Use CloudTrail to track API activity and security events.
 - Implement AWS X-Ray for end-to-end request tracing.
 8. AWS Certificate Manager
 - Request Certificate status was pending validation for several hours, CNAME entry in route 53 was added manually to resolve the issue.
 9. Set Appropriate TTL Values
 - Configure CloudFront's Minimum, Default, and Maximum TTL settings to control how long content stays cached, balancing performance with content freshness.

c. Future Enhancements

1. Implement Containerization
 - Migrate EC2-based deployment to Amazon ECS or EKS to improve scalability and management.
2. Advanced Auto Scaling
 - Use Predictive Auto Scaling to anticipate traffic patterns and scale accordingly.
3. Advanced Load Testing Strategies
 - Implement a continuous load testing pipeline to assess system performance under various traffic conditions.
 - Automate testing using AWS Distributed Load Testing.
4. Database Performance Scaling
 - Integrate ElastiCache (Redis/Memcached) to reduce direct database queries.
 - Use Aurora Serverless for auto-scaling database capacity during demand spikes.
5. Intelligent Auto Scaling with Machine Learning
 - Implement Predictive Scaling to anticipate traffic patterns and optimize scaling decisions.
6. Infrastructure as Code (IaC) for Better Maintainability
 - Use AWS CloudFormation or Terraform to define and manage infrastructure consistently.

7. Security and Compliance Enhancements
 - Enable AWS GuardDuty for real-time threat detection.
 - Implement AWS Config to enforce compliance with security best practices.
8. Leverage Origin Shield:
 - Enable CloudFront's Origin Shield to add an extra caching layer that reduces origin server load and enhances cache hit ratios.
9. **Redirect Overhead:**
 - The redirection introduces additional latency due to the extra round-trip between the client and the ALB before reaching CloudFront.

5. Screenshots of infrastructure deployment

1. Database: Configuration

midterm

Refresh

Modify

Actions

Summary

DB identifier
midterm

Status
Available

CPU
3.58%

Role
Instance

Class
db.t3.micro

Current activity
0 Connections

Engine
MySQL Community

Region & AZ
us-east-1b

Recommendations
3 Informational

Connectivity & security

Monitoring

Logs & events

Configuration

Zero-ETL integrations

Maintenance & updates

Instance

Configuration

DB instance ID
midterm

Engine version
8.0.40

RDS Extended Support
Disabled

DB name
ecommerce_1

License model
General Public License

Option groups
default:mysql-8-0 In sync

Amazon Resource Name (ARN)
arn:aws:rds:us-east-1:408110345239:db:midterm

Resource ID
db-
UQPZOV0AFDM6I4OUHI4AJDNX2E

Instance class

Instance class
db.t3.micro

vCPU
2

RAM
1 GB

Availability

Master username
admin

Master password

IAM DB authentication
Not enabled

Multi-AZ
Yes

Secondary Zone
us-east-1a

Storage

Encryption
Enabled

AWS KMS key
midterm-db

Storage type
General Purpose SSD (gp3)

Storage
20 GiB

Provisioned IOPS
3000 IOPS

Storage throughput
125 MiBps

Storage autoscaling
Enabled

Maximum storage threshold
1000 GiB

Storage file system configuration
Current

Monitoring

Monitoring type
Database Insights - Standard

Performance Insights
Disabled

Enhanced Monitoring
Enabled

Granularity
60 seconds

Monitoring role
arn:aws:iam::408110345239:role/rds-monitoring-role

DevOps Guru
Disabled

2. Database: Connectivity & Security

midterm

Refresh

Modify

Actions

Summary

DB identifier
midterm

Status
Available

CPU
3.58%

Role
Instance

Class
db.t3.micro

Current activity
0 Connections

Engine
MySQL Community

Region & AZ
us-east-1b

Recommendations
3 Informational

Connectivity & security

Monitoring

Logs & events

Configuration

Zero-ETL integrations

Maintenance & updates

Connectivity & security

Endpoint & port

Endpoint
midterm.cqloi8a0zm9.us-east-1.rds.amazonaws.com

Port
3306

Networking

Availability Zone
us-east-1b

VPC
vpc-0d40de49bd8dfb9ea

Subnet group
default-vpc-0d40de49bd8dfb9ea

Subnets
subnet-07e060aafb852483
subnet-0a5f95db55377f627
subnet-04699a18f5bc3b5df
subnet-0bc02d1ca388de1be
subnet-00527f2620432d819
subnet-06adb19f3c4726e6c

Network type
IPv4

Security

VPC security groups
db (sg-0254b2667c467a983)
Active

Publicly accessible
No

Certificate authority
Info
rds-ca-rsa2048-g1

Certificate authority date
May 25, 2061, 19:34 (UTC-04:00)

DB instance certificate expiration date
March 28, 2026, 22:27 (UTC-04:00)

3. AMI Creation

Image summary for ami-0930d4891cbcb9a1d

AMI ID  ami-0930d4891cbcb9a1d	Image type machine	Platform details Linux/UNIX	Root device type EBS
AMI name  midterm-ami-v3	Owner account ID  408110345239	Architecture x86_64	Usage operation RunInstances
Root device name  /dev/sda1	Status  Available	Source  408110345239/midterm-ami-v3	Virtualization type hvm
Boot mode uefi-preferred	State reason -	Creation date  2025-03-29T03:02:11.000Z	Kernel ID -
Description  updated db url	Product codes -	RAM disk ID -	Deprecation time -
Last launched time -	Block devices  /dev/sda1=snap-0db6bbd474e9d822a:8:true:gp3  /dev/sdb=ephemeral0  /dev/sdc=ephemeral1	Deregistration protection  Disabled	Allowed image -
Source AMI ID  ami-0c83bebe0f33b57c1	Source AMI Region us-east-1		

4. Auto-Scaling Group Launch Template

midterm-asglt (lt-0b9c99df0e0804dd7)

midterm-asglt (lt-0b9c99df0e0804dd7)

Actions

Delete template

Launch template details

Launch template ID

lt-0b9c99df0e0804dd7

Launch template name

midterm-asglt

Default version

3

Owner

arn:aws:iam::408110345239:user/ha
rsha

Details

Versions

Template tags

Launch template version details

Actions

Delete template version

Version

3 (Default)

Description

new db url

Date created

2025-03-29T03:05:02.000Z

Created by

arn:aws:iam::408110345239:user/ha
rsha

Instance details

Storage

Resource tags

Network interfaces

Advanced details

AMI ID

ami-0930d4891cbcb9a1d

Instance type

t2.micro

Availability Zone

-

Key pair name

midterm

Security groups

-

Security group IDs

sg-07f1f54f3fb32ff89

5. Auto-Scaling Group: Configuration

midterm-asg

midterm-asg Capacity overview [Edit](#)

[arm:aws:autoscaling:us-east-1:408110345239:autoScalingGroup:db1d025a-eba2-43d5-92e9-a100d1a3ee89:autoScalingGroupName/midterm-asg](#)

Desired capacity 2	Scaling limits (Min - Max) 1 - 3	Desired capacity type Units (number of instances)	Status Updating capacity
------------------------------	--	---	------------------------------------

Date created
Tue Mar 25 2025 14:26:27 GMT-0400 (Eastern Daylight Time)

[Details](#) | [Integrations - new](#) | [Automatic scaling](#) | [Instance management](#) | [Instance refresh](#) | [Activity](#) | [Monitoring](#)

Launch template [Edit](#)

Launch template
[lt-0b9c99df0e0804dd7](#)
midterm-asglt

Version
Default

Description
-

[View details in the launch template console](#)

AMI ID
[ami-0c83bebe0f33b57c1](#)

Security groups
-

Storage (volumes)
-

Instance type
t2.micro

Security group IDs
[sg-07f1f54f3fb32ff89](#)

Key pair name
midterm

Owner
arn:aws:iam::408110345239:user/harsha

Create time
Tue Mar 25 2025 14:05:43 GMT-0400 (Eastern Daylight Time)

Request Spot Instances
No

Network [Edit](#)

Availability Zones
us-east-1a, us-east-1b

Subnet ID
subnet-04699a18f5bc3b5df, subnet-0f7e060aafb852483

Availability Zone distribution
Balanced best effort

6. Auto-Scaling Group: Automatic Scaling

Dynamic scaling policies (2) [Info](#) [Refresh](#) [Actions](#) [Create dynamic scaling policy](#) < 1 >

midterm-asg-dsp-simple ☐

Policy type
Simple scaling

Enabled or disabled
Enabled

Execute policy when
midterm-asg-add-instance
breaches the alarm threshold: GroupTotalInstances >= 3 for 1 consecutive periods of 300 seconds for the metric dimensions:
AutoScalingGroupName = midterm-asg

Take the action
Add 1 capacity units

And then wait
300 seconds before allowing another scaling activity

Target Tracking Policy ☐

Policy type
Target tracking scaling

Enabled or disabled
Enabled

Execute policy when
As required to maintain Average CPU utilization at 50

Take the action
Add or remove capacity units as required

Instances need
300 seconds to warm up before including in metric

Scale in
Enabled

7. Application Load Balancer: Target Group

midterm-tg-http

[Actions](#)

Details

[arn:aws:elasticloadbalancing:us-east-1:408110345239:targetgroup/midterm-tg-http/678a674efd538aa1](#)

Target type
Instance

Protocol : Port
HTTP: 80

Protocol version
HTTP1

VPC
[vpc-0d40de49bd8dfb9ea](#)

IP address type
IPv4

Load balancer
[midterm-alb](#)

8. Application Load Balancer: Configuration

midterm-alb

[Actions](#)

▼ Details

Load balancer type
Application

Status
Active

VPC
[vpc-0d40de49bd8dfb9ea](#)

Load balancer IP address type
IPv4

Scheme
Internet-facing

Hosted zone
Z35SXDOTRQ7X7K

Availability Zones
[subnet-04699a18f5bc3b5df](#) us-east-1b (use1-az4)
[subnet-07e060aafb852483](#) us-east-1a (use1-az2)

Date created
March 25, 2025, 14:24 (UTC-04:00)

Load balancer ARN
[arn:aws:elasticloadbalancing:us-east-1:408110345239:loadbalancer/app/midterm-alb/40d293d6e3bec57](#)

DNS name info
[midterm-alb-1254806338.us-east-1.elb.amazonaws.com](#) (A Record)

[Listeners and rules](#) | [Network mapping](#) | [Resource map](#) | [Security](#) | [Monitoring](#) | [Integrations](#) | [Attributes](#) | [Capacity](#) | [Tags](#)

Listeners and rules (2) info

[Manage rules](#) | [Manage listener](#) | [Add listener](#)

A listener checks for connection requests on its configured protocol and port. Traffic received by the listener is routed according to the default action and any additional rules.

Protocol:Port	Default action	Rules	ARN	Security policy	Default SSL/TLS certificate	mTLS
HTTP5:443	Forward to target group midterm-tg-http: 1 (100%) - Target group stickiness: Off	2 rules	ARN	ELBSecurityPolicy-TLS13-1-2-...	enpm818n-grp21.online (Certi...	Off

9. S3 Bucket for storing Static Assets

[Amazon S3](#) > [Buckets](#) > [midterm-static-assets](#) > [assets/](#)

assets/

[Copy S3 URI](#)

[Objects](#) | [Properties](#)

Objects (4)

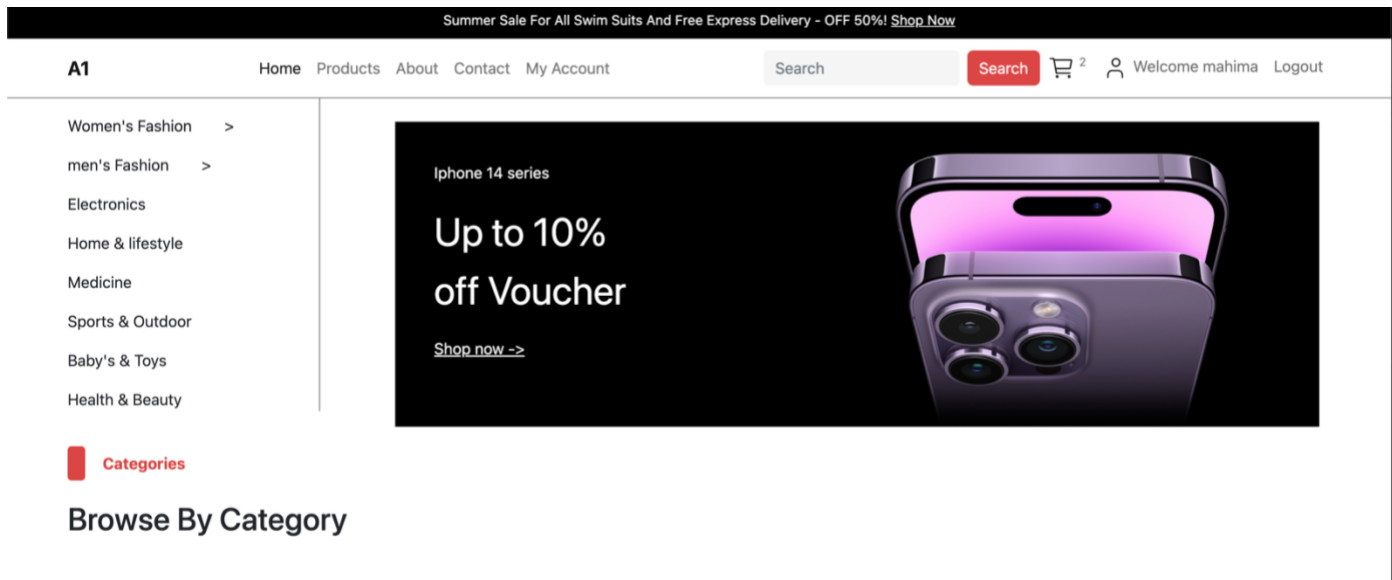
Objects are the fundamental entities stored in Amazon S3. You can use [Amazon S3 inventory](#) to get a list of all objects in your bucket. For others to access your objects, you'll need to explicitly grant them permissions. [Learn more](#)

Find objects by prefix

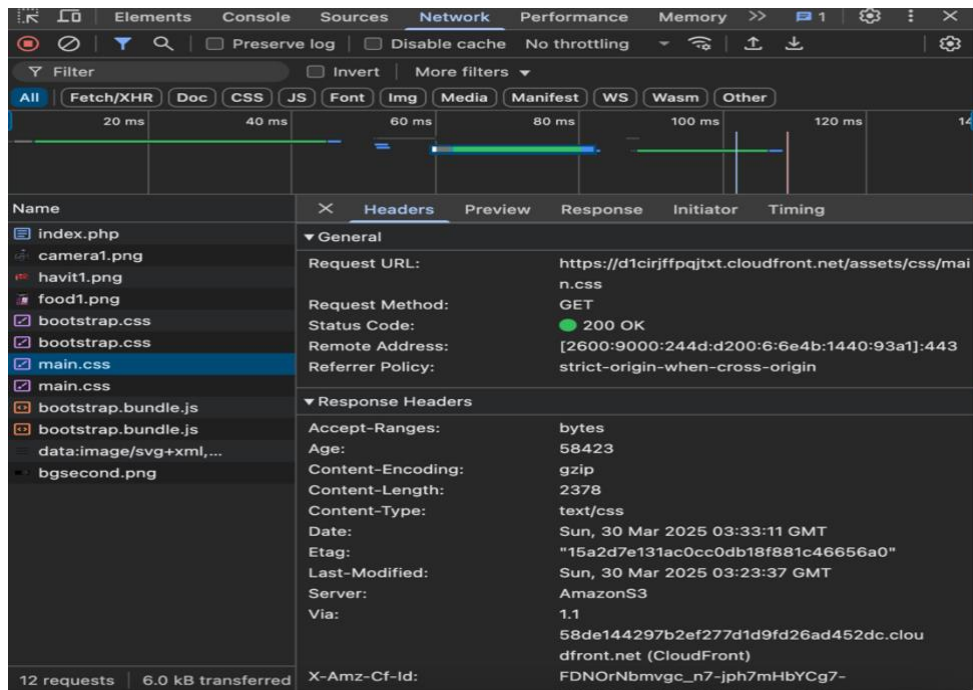
Show versions

Name	Type	Last modified	Size	Storage class
.DS_Store	DS_Store	March 26, 2025, 16:40:28 (UTC-04:00)	6.0 KB	Standard
css/	Folder	-	-	-
images/	Folder	-	-	-
js/	Folder	-	-	-

10. Able to Login as User



11. CloudFront Configuration



References:

<https://aws.amazon.com/premiumsupport/support-cloud-cost-optimization/>
<https://docs.aws.amazon.com/awscloudtrail/latest/userguide/best-practices-security.html>
<https://docs.aws.amazon.com/AmazonCloudFront/latest/DeveloperGuide/Introduction.html>
<https://docs.aws.amazon.com/autoscaling/ec2/userguide/what-is-amazon-ec2-auto-scaling.html>
https://docs.aws.amazon.com/AmazonRDS/latest/UserGuide/USER_CreateDBInstance.html
<https://docs.aws.amazon.com/acm/latest/userguide/certificate-validation.html>
<https://docs.aws.amazon.com/elasticloadbalancing/latest/application/load-balancer-listeners.html>
<https://docs.aws.amazon.com/AmazonRDS/latest/UserGuide/UsingWithRDS.SSL.html>
<https://docs.aws.amazon.com/waf/latest/developerguide/waf-rules.html>
<https://docs.aws.amazon.com/AmazonCloudFront/latest/DeveloperGuide/distribution-working-with.html>